Staff answers and evaluation checks

Design and Technology LAUNCH Spring 2 Week 4 Thursday 18 March 2027 P1 Year A

Strength and finish

Strength is the body and joins supporting the intended load. Finish is the quality of edges, folds, tape and channel. Neat tape alone is not proof of strength; a standing card alone does not show all edges are safe. Accept actual observations and an explanation of their limits.

Core normal use test

One actual 80 mm wide by 60 mm high lightweight paper card sits centrally in the U channel against the slope. The actual stand is on a level table within a 160 by 120 mm overall table area. The body base alone is 120 by 80 mm. After adult clearance, hands away for 30 seconds. Stop at the first warning, remove as directed and inspect. Record actual count, time and observations. No heavy weights are needed.

Fair before and after

Keep the same card, position, table and timing target. Recheck one card first after a change. Actual seconds may be less than 30 if stopped; record that time and reason. A baseline not performed for safety remains not performed. Do not invent a before result to complete a table.

Useful improvement

Accept a safe actual change linked to a real finding: for example, replacing a loose tape end neatly or correcting an approved channel alignment. The pupil explains why it helps and records actual support. Do not deliberately weaken work, invent a defect or call a proposal a completed improvement.

Adhesive alternatives

The default uses cold paper tape. Any actual approved adhesive join must complete its full label cure before a test. The adult checks the actual instructions. No invented cure time or hot glue route.

Staff stop rules and questions

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Hinge and parallel check

Hinge: no, do not add a card after a tilt. Stop, remove the load as directed and inspect. Parallel: no, after repair do not begin with three cards. Adult clears the item and the one-card normal-use test comes first. Reteach stop, ask and one-card recheck before practical work continues.

Optional Stretch comparison

Optional Stretch comparison only: first pass the one-card baseline and ask the adult to clear the next stage. Use a second identical lightweight paper card, then a third, maximum three cards total. Each is 80 mm by 60 mm and made from the same lightweight paper; no added clips, lamination or weights. Observe for 30 seconds at each stage. Remove cards and inspect between stages. Stop at the first concern; never add another card after a stop. Keep card size and material, position, level table and timing the same. The purpose is still one card. This is a comparison, not a maximum load or safety claim.

What the evidence cannot prove

A three-card comparison is not a maximum capacity, universal strength figure or safety certificate. No force, grams or weight claim is needed. More cards do not complete the core outcome. A model picture cannot prove actual strength or tactile edge quality.

Cold call with response choice

Foundation: What is our intended load? Expected: one 80 by 60 mm lightweight paper card.

Middle: How do we compare a change fairly? Expected: keep the same card, central position, level table and timing target; record real results.

Higher: What does a successful three-card comparison leave unproven? Expected: loads not tested, maximum capacity and safe use for other objects.

Keep gaps honest

The pupil may direct adult handling and confirm a record. Record the roles. If there is no actual item or safe test route, model evaluation can support understanding while practical testing and improvement remain pending.